

Only AOP and the free-energy principle return a verdict on every case;
the other three rivals are silent or out of scope on a third of the set

	AOP decoupled reference	R1 chemical- Darwinian	R2 auto- poiesis	R3 chemoton (Gánti)	R4 assembly theory	R5 free-energy principle	
A1 <i>E. coli</i> , exponential							Tier A — paradigm
A2 Human hepatocyte							
A3 Dormant <i>B. subtilis</i> spore							
A4 Heat-killed spore							
A5 Naked T4 virion							
A6 Candle flame							
A7 Main-sequence star							
A8 NaCl crystal							
B1 Mimivirus							Tier B — hard biological
B2 PrP-Sc prion							
B3 Mature erythrocyte							
B4 Tardigrade tun							
B5 JCVI-syn3A							
B6 <i>Buchnera aphidicola</i>							
B7 Sterile worker bee							
B8 Metastatic cancer cell							
C1 Bimetallic thermostat							Tier C — non-biological
C2 PID cruise controller							
C3 Spacecraft fault mgmt							
C4 Chemostat (operator-run)							
C5 Belousov-Zhabotinsky							
C6 RAF autocatalytic set							
C7 Computer worm							
C8 LLM agent + health check							
D1 Ant colony							Tier D — the embarrassing ones
D2 Corporation + treasury policy							
D3 Central bank + target							
D4 Earth climate system							
D5 Thermostat + owner							
D6 Mousetrap							
D7 Sprinkler system							
D8 Seed bank							

- alive / positive
- paused / second tier
- not alive / negative
- contested in the rival's own literature
- undetermined — evidential gap
- silent — literature does not adjudicate
- out of scope by the rival's own gate
- corner mark = the rival's own authors ruled this case (cited, not derived); unmarked cells are this seat's extension of the rival to a case its literature did not decide